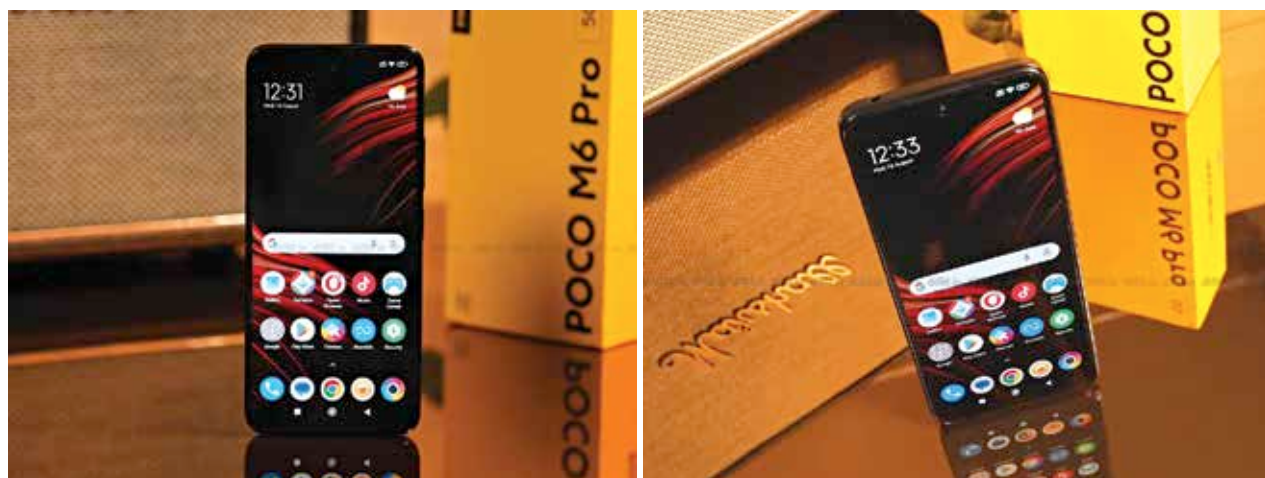




the Snapdragon 4 Gen 1 on the Redmi Note 12. We saw a significant lead in GeekBench as well. However, the phone scored lower than the Redmi Note 12 in PCMark Work.

In GPU benchmarks, the phone scored 662 in 3D Mark Wild Life, which sadly didn't match up to the Helio G88's performance. The pattern repeated in GFXBench's Aztec Ruins and Car Chase tests. So, the POCO M6 Pro with its Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 is a great phone for productivity and daily tasks but is not up to par with competition when it comes to gaming.

I played Call of Duty: Mobile and BGMI on this phone, and on Low graphics, I saw little to no frame drops. It is only when I pushed the graphics up to medium that I began to see some frame skips. So, I would say you can definitely game on this phone, but keep your expectations in check – it is not meant to be a monster gaming device. Basic tasks such as SMS, social media, calls, and web browsing are handled with ease and even Sheets and Docs work smoothly.

Moving on to software, MIUI is brimming with customisations, but it is also brimming with bloatware. There are several preinstalled games, a bunch of preinstalled social media apps like LinkedIn, Moj, and Snapchat, and many Xiaomi apps. It is an overwhelmingly crowded experience, so be warned, if you like a clean interface, look elsewhere.

CAMERAS

Like the Redmi 12 5G, the POCO M6 Pro sports a dual rear camera setup. You get a 50 MP primary camera with an f/1.8 aperture and a 2 MP depth sensor. Images from the primary lens have decent detail but the dynamic range could be better. The highlights are almost always overblown but the shadows have good detail.

Portrait images have good bokeh – maybe a touch too aggressive – but you can adjust the levels are clicking the picture. Edge detection is mediocre, the cutout isn't always very accurate. Selfies look decent from the 8 MP camera, the skin tone is surprisingly natural but the detail is quite soft.

There's support for 1080p at 30 fps video from the front and rear cameras, and the video footage is nothing spectacular. It works in daylight, but low-light results are grainy and noisy.

BATTERY LIFE

Equipped with a 5,000 mAh battery, the POCO M6 Pro has impressive battery life. I consistently saw the phone lasting for 1-2 days with ease. The phone has a screen-on time of about 6-7 hours. In my tests, it lost about 8 per cent battery when running Google Maps for an hour and just 4 per cent battery when playing Call of Duty: Mobile for 15 minutes.

The 18 W charging speeds are quite slow though, by 2023 standards. The retail box comes with a 22.5 W charging brick, but the charging wattage maxes

out at 18 W. The POCO M6 Pro took a good 1 hour and 57 minutes to go from empty to full battery, which is excruciatingly slow.

VERDICT

The POCO M6 Pro 5G delivers on what it promises – an affordable 5G phone experience with reliable performance and solid battery life. It democratises the technology for the masses, and being the most affordable 5G smartphone in the market, it doesn't cut too many corners – making it a decent, well-rounded experience. You've got a massive battery, a large 90 Hz display, and an eye-catching design. The misses in the camera and charging departments can be forgiven for the overall package the POCO M6 Pro 5G provides. It gets a definite thumbs-up from me for someone looking for a capable 5G smartphone that won't break the bank!

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 4 Gen 2 | RAM: 4/6 GB LPDDR4X | Internal storage: 64/128 GB UFS 2.2 | Expandable storage: Yes, up to 1 TB | OS: Android 13, MIUI 14 | 5G bands: n1, n3, n5, n8, n28, n40, n78 | Display: 6.79-inch FHD+, 550 nits peak brightness | Display refresh rate: 90 Hz | Cameras (rear): 50 MP + 2 MP | Front camera: 8 MP | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 18 W | Thickness: 8.17 mm | Weight: 199 g | IP rating: IP53

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